

Just like Goggles

Nokia to bring Augmented Reality mobile devices to India by 2011

Infosys launches Flypp

Flypp is a back end platform for mobile service providers, to provide a variety of content to users

Google Goggles Goes Live

There have been demo videos of Google Goggles at work for some time now, and the service finally went live last month. Google Goggles is an application that you install on your mobile phone that uses an image as the basis for searching images online. This follows close on the heels of Amazon's iPhone app that essentially does the same thing. However, Google's other services offer a range of interesting mashups with Google Goggles. Right now Google Goggles is available as a free application for the select few who are using Android based devices. This means that if you spot a product in a supermarket, and snap the bar code, you will get competing deals from nearby locations, using a combination of Google Search, GPS and Google Maps.

Photographing an object is the same as entering the same entry into search engines, so a book or a painting will get you background information as if you entered the search manually. This means that users can search for things they cannot



A demo of what Google Goggles does

describe in words, or don't yet know how to. Clicking a business card, scans the information allowing you to add the information to contacts or to dial a number immediately. A live search feature allows a user to point the camera around, without even clicking, and related results scroll along the bottom of the screen like a ticker. This works well only for areas covered well by Google Street view though.

Some of the applications planned are a little unbelievable though, including recognising particular trees based on a single leaf. Head out to <http://www.google.com/mobile/goggles/> for more.

Nokia's Booklet 3G launched

The Finnish mobile giant has just stepped up into new territory by releasing the Booklet 3D, and nobody is really sure what to call it. This will probably be the first of the new wave of Smartbooks to hit the streets, something that is a cross



between a Smartphone and a Netbook. Officially called a "mini laptop", the monickers for these kinds of devices are getting increasingly diverse and confusing. The device has a 10.1-inch HD screen and a QWERTY keyboard, with a hinge in between, so calling it a laptop wouldn't be too off the mark. The Booklet 3G is built with a range of connectivity options including Wi-Fi, WLAN, a 3G modem, on board GPS and a hot-swappable SIM card that goes directly into the body.

The Booklet 3G incorporates some of the sensibilities of their mobile phone range, in terms of build quality and feature mix. There is an impressive 12 hour battery life, which is supposed to last through at least one heavy work day without the need to be connected to a plug point. The Booklet 3G is powered by an Atom Z530, 1.6 GHz processor on a fanless chipset, with Windows 7 installed by default. In terms of memory, the device sports 1 GB RAM, and 120 GB hard disk space, which is an ample amount for such gadgets. There are a bunch of software bundled too, which is supposed to make connectivity simple for users, the Ovi suite featuring prominently. Strangely enough, the device

also has an accelerometer, we don't really know why, but usages are bound to emerge.

IMEI fiasco does not dent China made phone sales

The Government banned phones without IMEI numbers from December 1. While this effectively put a lot of cheap mobile phones out of circulation, the wide open gap in the market was taken up by "Indian Brands" of mobile phones, which are highly local mobile phone manufacturers, providing impressive feature list and imitation devices along the lines of established mobile phone manufacturers. While these do have IMEI numbers, be wary of such devices as they have the same low shelf life and bad design quality of the Chinese mobile phones. In fact, although the mobile phones have an Indian local brand on the packaging and the casing, these mobile phones are still produced in China and imported into India. So the "Indian Brand" is nothing but a rehashed versions of the Chinese Mobile phones.

The official mechanism for converting an illegal, IMEI-less device into a legal one has ended in the month of December itself, and despite what local advertisers or service providers might tell you, there is now no official way to get an IMEI number to your phone if it already does not have one. The best thing to do in case you own such a device is to trash it, and pick up a legitimate model with a legal IMEI code. **d**



The Nokia Booklet 3G